Clever Investor Platform

Product & Org Proposal

Prepared for Luke Babich & Ben Mizes · March 2026

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CONFIDENTIAL

STRUCTURE

What this proposal covers

01 **Situation**

Where Clever Offers is today — what mystery shopping revealed

02 **The Gap**

5 UX gaps, structural conflict of interest, competitive benchmarks

03 **The Hypothesis**

What the Investor Platform could be — and why it's the right bet

04 **Product Proposal**

Scrappiest path to validation, consumer experience, data schema + AI

05 **Org & Resources**

Team constraints, what to protect, how to staff and sequence

06 **Open Questions**

What I'd want to explore with you in this session

Key assumptions & how I prepared

What I did

— Mystery shopped cleveroffers.com end-to-end

— Spoke with 2 Clever-connected agents (Luke Smith, Jacob Mkhitarian) — 17 and 12 min calls

— Mystery shopped InvestorLift and HomeLight Simple Sale

— Reviewed Luke's async answers on team structure, growth signals, and investor relationships

What I'm assuming

— No formal market research — the thesis is grounded in Clever's first-hand experience with sellers, investors, and agents

— Hiring timelines of 4–12 weeks are realistic, not optimistic

— AMP is P1 and fully protected — no pull from that team

— Flat hiring cost assumed by role type (PM ~$160K, Eng ~$180K, fully loaded)

— ATLAS enterprise fire drills are unpredictable — I've treated that team as unavailable

What I'd still want to know

— Conversion rate from submit → investor offer accepted (current baseline)

— Who owns the early investor-matching work and what's been built

— Whether any investor relationships have yielded repeat transactions

SITUATION — CURRENT STATE

What the seller experience actually looks like today

Homepage
Zip → See Cash Offers

Property + address
Low friction, clean UX

Contact gate
Name/email/phone required before anything shown

⚠️ **Conversion chokepoint**
Contact required before value shown

"Offers on the way"
No timeline. No dashboard. No status.

⚠️ **Dead zone**
No persistence. No seller account.

Agent calls
Not investors. No context. No account.

⚠️ **Channel conflict**
Agent incentive is to convert to listing

In-person visit
Required before any investor sees property

⚠️ **Visit bottleneck**
Adds 1–2 weeks before investor sees property

First-hand finding:

Both mystery-shopped agents spent the first 2 minutes on investor options, then 15+ minutes pitching traditional listings. The platform promises cash offers — sellers get agent calls, then silence. There is no Clever account to land on after submission.

COMPETITIVE CONTEXT

The market has already solved pieces of this

Clever Offers

WHAT CLEVER OWNS

- ✓ Trusted consumer brand (4.9★, 3,400+ reviews)
- ✓ 18,000+ agent network, validated seller funnel
- ✓ 30% of revenue — growing 250% YoY
- ✗ No buy-box matching, no investor platform
- ✗ Experience ends at submission

Consumer trust — missing the backend

HomeLight Simple Sale

BEST CONSUMER COMP

- ✓ Named investor network surfaced to seller
- ✓ Explicit investor vs. agent path choice
- ✓ Structured intake call feeds pricing model
- ✓ No in-person visit before investor sees property
- ✗ Smaller agent network than Clever

Right consumer model — weaker network

InvestorLift

BEST INVESTOR-SIDE COMP

- ✓ AI buy-box matching — investor sets criteria
- ✓ 5M+ investors, $30B+ offers made
- ✓ AI deal scoring + in-app negotiation
- ✓ Live marketplace visible before sign-up
- ✗ B2B only — no consumer-safe experience

Best matching intelligence — no B2C layer

THE HYPOTHESIS

This isn't about a new product. It's about building the intelligence layer the front-end already promises.

Clever already has what HomeLight and InvestorLift lack: a trusted consumer brand, a validated seller funnel, and 18,000 agents. The gaps are entirely on the investor side — no buy-box matching, no structured intake, no platform behind the promise. The Investor Platform closes that gap.

C — **Consumer trust**
Clever already owns the seller relationship

H — **HomeLight model**
Parallel paths, named network, structured intake

IL — **InvestorLift intelligence**
Buy-box matching, AI scoring, in-app negotiation

= Clever Investor Platform
InvestorLift-style backend · Clever's consumer front-end

PRODUCT PROPOSAL — REC 1

Rec 1: Replace the dead zone with a scheduling moment

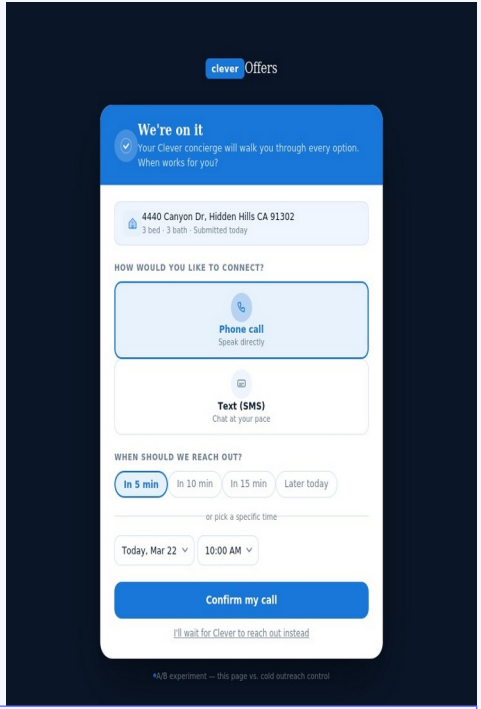
Current — what sellers receive today

- ✗ "Cash offers are on the way!" — no timeline
- ✗ CX assigns agent (seller unaware)
- ✗ Unclear voicemail + cold text introduction
- ✗ Two agent intros, no context on who or why
- ✗ No Clever account to land on

→

Proposed: seller-scheduled

- ✓ **Channel selection**
  Phone or SMS
- ✓ **Quick-time chips**
  5 / 10 / 15 min / later today
- ✓ **Date + time picker**
  Specific scheduling
- ✓ **Concierge pre-briefed**
  Preferences sent ahead of call
- ✓ **Account created**
  First persistent identity layer



A/B Experiment: Control (cold outreach) vs. Test A (scheduled · phone only) vs. Test B (scheduled · channel choice) — primary metric: submit → concierge connection rate

PRODUCT PROPOSAL — REC 2

Rec 2: Give sellers a place to land and a reason to engage

Personalized home card

Address, submitted date, property details — the seller sees their home, not a generic confirmation

5-step progress tracker

Submitted → Call scheduled → Explore options → Get offers → Decide. Seller always knows where they are

Local market snapshot

Median price, avg DOM, list-to-sale ratio for their zip. Educates before the concierge call

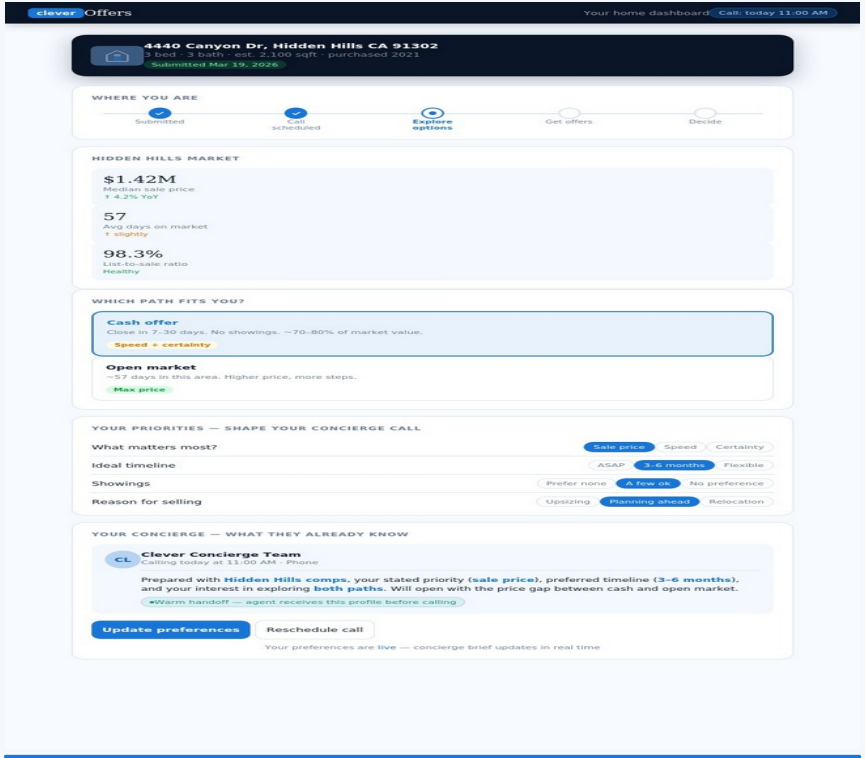
Interactive path comparison

Cash offer vs. open market — side-by-side with local estimates. Seller selects preference

Preference module → agent brief

Priority, timeline, showing comfort, reason for selling. Selections generate a structured brief the concierge inherits

Foundation, not a feature — creates the first persistent Clever seller account. Every future feature lives here.



↗ Interact live: clever-seller-dashboard.html

STRATEGIC CONTEXT

This isn't a Clever Offers feature. It's the account layer that makes Clever a platform.

Clever's business model ends at the referral across every product line. The post-submit account layer — seller identity, preferences, market context — has direct compounding value beyond Offers.

Agent Matching

CORE BUSINESS

Seller preferences (timeline, priority, path) make every agent match warmer and more informed. Same data schema, same infrastructure — zero additional build required.

Now: Cold lead → agent call with no context

Clever Pro

LENDER CHANNEL

Seller account data — mortgage balance, timeline, reason for selling, financial priority — is mortgage pre-qualification signal. Raw leads become enriched pipeline for lender partners.

Now: Raw contact passed to lender with no intent data

Clever Title

CLOSING SERVICES

A seller who has a dashboard and a progress tracker is a natural place to introduce title and escrow mid-journey — at the Get Offers stage, not as a cold pitch at close.

Now: Title introduced at close — unfamiliar, cold, last minute

Gravy / Lifecycle

LONG-TERM LOYALTY

The Gravy acquisition was about owning the pre-purchase journey. A seller dashboard is the same thesis applied to the sell side — Clever holding the relationship across the journey, not just at the transaction.

Now: Clever exits after referral — no post-transaction relationship

Seller preferences become structured data — LLM turns data into a brief

seller_profile

seller_id · address · property_type

beds · baths · est_sqft · purchase_year

improvements[ ] · est_mortgage_balance

channel_preference · concierge_scheduled_at

seller_preferences

path_preference (investor | open_market | undecided)

primary_priority · ideal_timeline

showing_comfort · reason_for_selling

path_card_clicks[ ] — behavioral signal

time_on_page · sections_viewed[ ]

market_context

zip · median_sale_price · avg_days_on_market

list_to_sale_ratio · yoy_price_change

investor_activity_score

comparable_cash_offer_range[ ]

open_market_estimate_range[ ]

path_card_clicks[ ] — behavioral signal no CRM captures today

↓ LLM

Agent brief (LLM output):

"Varun is a 3bd/3ba homeowner in Hidden Hills who purchased in 2021 and has made meaningful improvements (landscaping, garage office, patio). He's planning ahead for aging parents — no urgency. He leaned toward cash offers but listed sale price as his top priority, which is a tension worth surfacing early. Local market: median $1.42M, 57 DOM. Cash offer range: $980K–$1.15M vs. open market $1.35M–$1.48M. Lead with the price gap and let him decide."

PRODUCT PROPOSAL — INVESTOR PLATFORM

The scrappiest path to validating the investor matching hypothesis

Phase 1

Month 1–2 · Loveable

Structured intake + manual routing

→ Agent collects property package via structured Loveable form (photos, details, timeline)

→ Clever platform routes to curated investor shortlist — no agent personal lists

→ Investor responses tracked in Airtable/Sheets (not yet version-controlled)

→ Validation metric: do structured packages generate more investor responses than ad-hoc agent outreach?

Phase 2

Month 3–4 · +ANVIL

Buy-box matching + algorithmic routing

→ ANVIL builds investor buy-box scoring — adjacent to existing match models

→ Property intake auto-routes to investors whose buy-box criteria match

→ Seller dashboard surfaces: 'X investors reviewing your home'

→ Validation metric: does buy-box matching increase offer volume per submission?

Phase 3

Month 5+ · Full build

Competing offers dashboard

→ Seller sees competing offers forming in real time — side by side with open market estimate

→ In-platform negotiation layer (vs. agent-mediated verbal relay)

→ Agent shifts from bottleneck → advisor: in the loop on offers, not generating them

→ Validation metric: submit → offer acceptance rate vs. control

Key constraint: Phase 1 and 2 require no tech allocation from AMP, ATLAS, or Agent HQ. Phase 3 requires ANVIL partial and a dedicated new pod.

RESOURCE ALLOCATION

What to protect, what to borrow, what to build

AMP

PROTECT

P1 — fully staffed. Zero pull. This is the engine. Do not touch.

ATLAS

PROTECT

Too stretched + enterprise fire drill risk. Unavailable for net-new work.

Agent HQ

PROTECT

Understaffed due to attrition. Fix the backfill first. Don't add scope.

ANVIL

PHASE 2 ONLY

Named as intended Phase 2 partner for buy-box scoring — adjacent to existing match models. Not committed until capacity confirmed in live session. If unavailable, buy-box logic is an early engineering hire deliverable.

Growth

1 SPRINT

Funnel instrumentation for the A/B experiment only. One shared sprint with Ben's team.

NEW POD

BUILD

Mandate: Offers investor matching + post-submit account layer (cross-product). 1 PM, Month 1. Engineers gated on Phase 1 signal: 15%+ investor response lift OR 3 investor matches in 30 days. Reporting structure: open question for live session.

Phase 1 requires zero pull from any existing pod — Loveable + dedicated PM only. Engineering gated on signal: 15%+ investor response lift OR 3 investor matches in 30 days. ANVIL capacity and new pod reporting structure are open questions for the live session.

RECOMMENDATION

The call.

1

Rec 1: Ship the scheduling screen now

It's Loveable-executable, requires no tech allocation, and directly fixes the highest-friction point in the current flow. It also creates the first seller account — the foundation for everything else.

2

Rec 2: Build the seller dashboard in parallel

The preference module generates the data schema. The LLM turns it into agent briefs. The A/B experiment runs itself. This is the concierge upgrade that makes warm handoffs systematic — not dependent on individual agent quality.

3

Start Phase 1 investor intake with Loveable

Replace the agent personal-list blast with a structured property package and a platform-owned investor routing layer. No new tech team required for Month 1. Signal within 6–8 weeks.

4

Gate Phase 2 on Phase 1 signal

Only pull ANVIL and fund the new pod when Phase 1 shows offer volume improvement. Don't build the matching engine on a hypothesis — build it on evidence.

LIVE SESSION AGENDA

What I'd want to dig into with you

The early investor-matching work

10 min

Who owns it, what's been built, what's worked and what hasn't. I want to build on what exists, not past it.

New pod sequencing

10 min

Does this start under Ben's team for Phase 1 and graduate at Phase 2, or does it need dedicated ownership from Month 1?

Pressure-test the Phase 1 scope

10 min

Does the structured intake + Loveable routing proposal fit the Offers team's actual capacity? What am I missing about current dependencies?

What's been tried and didn't work

10 min

What has Clever already tested on Offers that didn't land? That signal is as valuable as what did.

ANVIL capacity and the Phase 2 gate

10 min

Is ANVIL available for Phase 2 buy-box scoring, or does that need to be an early engineering hire? This changes how I'd sequence the pod build.

Reactions and open curveballs

10 min

Where am I wrong? What assumptions are off? What's the thing you're not sure I understand yet about how Clever actually works?